

State-Level US Macroeconomic Data

A source directory categorised by macro factor, indicator, and geographic coverage (states contained)

This report maps where to obtain US state-level macro data across the requested factors: employment, unemployment, wage growth, inflation, consumer sentiment, retail sales, industrial production, and imports/exports. Each entry lists the primary source, a direct link, the geographic coverage (which states are contained), and the publication frequency. Several requested indicators have **no official state-level series**; for these, defensible proxies are flagged **[PROXY]** and explained.

Reading the tags: **[PROXY]** = no direct state series exists; this is a substitute or build-it-yourself input. **[DISCONTINUED]** = historical data only, do not build a live pipeline on it.

Labor market - employment & unemployment

Macro indicator	Source & link	Geographic coverage (states contained)	Frequency
Unemployment rate, labor force, household employment	BLS - Local Area Unemployment Statistics (LAUS) www.bls.gov/lau/	50 states + DC + Puerto Rico; also counties, metros, cities	Monthly
Nonfarm payrolls, hours, avg earnings by industry	BLS - State & Metro Area Employment, Hours & Earnings (CES / SAE) www.bls.gov/sae/	50 states + DC + Puerto Rico; metro areas	Monthly
Initial & continued unemployment-insurance claims	US DOL ETA - Unemployment Insurance Claims oui.doleta.gov/unemploy/claims.asp	50 states + DC + Puerto Rico + US Virgin Islands	Weekly
Job openings, hires, separations	BLS - State JOLTS www.bls.gov/jlt/state-job-openings-rates.htm	50 states + DC (modeled estimates)	Monthly

Labor market - wages & earnings

Macro indicator	Source & link	Geographic coverage (states contained)	Frequency
Avg weekly wages & employment by detailed industry	BLS - Quarterly Census of Employment & Wages (QCEW) www.bls.gov/cew/	50 states + DC + PR + VI; counties (95%+ of US jobs)	Quarterly / annual
Average hourly / weekly earnings (total private)	BLS - CES State & Metro (SAE) www.bls.gov/sae/	50 states + DC + Puerto Rico	Monthly
Wage levels by occupation	BLS - Occupational Employment & Wage Statistics (OEWS) www.bls.gov/oes/	50 states + DC + territories; metros & balance-of-state	Semi-annual
Wages & salaries (compensation component of income)	BEA - Personal Income by State (earnings detail) www.bea.gov/data/income-saving/personal-income-by-state	50 states + DC	Quarterly

Income & output

Macro indicator	Source & link	Geographic coverage (states contained)	Frequency
Gross domestic product by state, by industry	BEA - GDP by State www.bea.gov/data/gdp/gdp-state	50 states + DC (territories published separately)	Quarterly / annual
Personal income & its components	BEA - Personal Income by State www.bea.gov/data/income-saving/personal-income-by-state	50 states + DC; also county & metro	Quarterly / annual
Real personal income (price-adjusted)	BEA - Real Personal Income by State www.bea.gov/data/economic-accounts/regional	50 states + DC; metros	Annual

Prices & inflation (no official state-level CPI exists)

Macro indicator	Source & link	Geographic coverage (states contained)	Frequency
Consumer price index - nearest official geography	BLS - Local & Regional CPI [PROXY] www.bls.gov/cpi/regional-resources.htm	4 census regions + ~23 large metros (NOT individual states)	Monthly / bi-monthly
Cross-state price LEVELS (spatial deflator)	BEA - Regional Price Parities by State & Metro [PROXY] www.bea.gov/data/prices-inflation/regional-price-p	50 states + DC; metro areas	Annual
State quarterly inflation rates (academic, build-on)	Hazell, Herreno, Nakamura & Steinsson - State CPI [PROXY] sites.google.com/view/jadhazell/state-consumer-pri	50 states (1978-2018; needs extending)	Quarterly (historical)

Composite economic activity

Macro indicator	Source & link	Geographic coverage (states contained)	Frequency
Single-factor index of general state activity	Philadelphia Fed - State Coincident Indexes www.philadelphiafed.org/surveys-and-data/regiona	50 states	Monthly
6-month-ahead growth of the coincident index	Philadelphia Fed - State Leading Indexes [DISCONTINUED] www.philadelphiafed.org/surveys-and-data/regiona	50 states (historical only - no longer published)	Monthly (ended)

Industrial & manufacturing activity (no official state IP series)

Macro indicator	Source & link	Geographic coverage (states contained)	Frequency
Manufacturing employment & hours (activity proxy)	BLS - QCEW / CES State [PROXY] www.bls.gov/cew/	50 states + DC + PR + VI	Monthly / quarterly
Industrial electricity sales (output proxy)	EIA - Electricity Data (state) [PROXY] www.eia.gov/electricity/data.php	50 states + DC	Monthly
Manufacturing business conditions surveys	Regional Fed surveys (NY Empire, Philly, Richmond, Dallas, KC) [PROXY] www.dallasfed.org/research/surveys	Federal Reserve districts (regional, not single states)	Monthly

Consumer spending & retail (no monthly official state retail series)

Macro indicator	Source & link	Geographic coverage (states contained)	Frequency
State & local sales-tax collections (spending proxy)	Census - Quarterly Summary of State & Local Tax Revenue (QTAX) [PROXY] www.census.gov/programs-surveys/qtax.html	50 states + DC (state aggregates)	Quarterly
Retail trade structural detail	Census - Annual Retail Trade Survey / Economic Census [PROXY] www.census.gov/retail/	National; selected state & metro (Economic Census)	Annual / 5-yearly
Real-time card spending by state	Private card panels (see Alternative Sources) [PROXY] tracktherecovery.org/	50 states + DC + counties (vendor dependent)	Daily / weekly

Consumer sentiment (no official state-level survey)

Macro indicator	Source & link	Geographic coverage (states contained)	Frequency
Consumer sentiment - nearest official geography	University of Michigan - Surveys of Consumers [PROXY] www.sca.isr.umich.edu/	National + 4 census regions (NOT states)	Monthly
State-level daily consumer confidence (commercial)	Morning Consult - Consumer Confidence [PROXY] pro.morningconsult.com/trackers/u-s-consumer-confidence	50 states (commercial subscription)	Daily

External trade (imports & exports)

Macro indicator	Source & link	Geographic coverage (states contained)	Frequency
Merchandise exports by state of origin	Census - State Trade Data (Foreign Trade) www.census.gov/foreign-trade/data/index.html	50 states + DC + PR + VI; by partner country & HS/NAICS	Monthly / quarterly
Interactive export/import query tool (now free)	Census - USA Trade Online usatrade.census.gov/	50 states + DC + PR + VI; districts & ~400 ports	Monthly
Programmatic trade data access	Census - International Trade API www.census.gov/data/developers/data-sets/international-trade...	State / port (2013-present)	Monthly
Trade + tariff query interface	USITC - DataWeb dataweb.usitc.gov/	National / state with tariff detail	Monthly / annual

Housing, construction & business formation (leading proxies)

Macro indicator	Source & link	Geographic coverage (states contained)	Frequency
Residential building permits (classic state leading signal)	Census - Building Permits Survey [PROXY] www.census.gov/construction/bps/	50 states + DC + regions; metros & places	Monthly
House price index	FHFA - House Price Index [PROXY] www.fhfa.gov/data/hpi	50 states + DC; metros	Quarterly / monthly
New business applications (real-time activity)	Census - Business Formation Statistics (BFS) [PROXY] www.census.gov/econ/bfs/	50 states + DC + regions	Weekly / monthly

Data-currency caveats (2025-2026)

Philadelphia Fed State Leading Indexes discontinued. The Philadelphia Fed has decided to no longer release the state leading indexes (the post-2020 break in initial-claims behaviour degraded the 6-month-change estimation). The State Coincident Indexes continue. Historical leading-index data remain available.

BLS state unemployment-rate gap, October 2025. State unemployment-rate data were not available for the October 2025 reference period, which forced a methodology change in the coincident index. Build state models to tolerate occasional missing months and revisions.

Census trade data now free. As of March 2025, all international-trade products previously behind a USA Trade Online subscription are available to the public at no cost.

No official state series for CPI, industrial production, retail sales, or consumer sentiment. These four requested indicators have no direct state-level official release. Use the flagged proxies (regional/metro CPI and BEA Regional Price Parities for prices; manufacturing employment/hours and EIA industrial electricity for IP; sales-tax receipts and card panels for retail; UMich regional and card spending for sentiment), or build bespoke series from microdata.

Opportunity Insights Economic Tracker - verify currency. This was built as a COVID-era real-time tool. Confirm it is still actively updated before operational use, and note the providers' own caveat that the state-level employment series carries meaningful noise relative to the CPS.

Aggregators & APIs - fastest way to assemble a state panel

Source	Notes
FRED / FRED Maps (St. Louis Fed) fred.stlouisfed.org/	Free. Practical default - mirrors most BLS/BEA/Census/Philly Fed state series with a clean API and map tools.
BLS / BEA / Census public APIs www.census.gov/data/developers.html	Free programmatic access to the primary-source series above (BLS: bls.gov/developers ; BEA: apps.bea.gov/API).
DBnomics db.nomics.world/	Free aggregator with a single API spanning BLS, BEA and Census.
IPUMS-CPS / IPUMS-USA www.ipums.org/	Harmonized microdata for building custom state aggregates (e.g. bespoke wage-growth or labor-flow measures).
Haver Analytics www.haver.com/	Commercial. Deep US regional coverage incl. the Philly Fed coincident series and state databases.
Moody's Analytics www.economy.com/	Commercial. Large state database plus state-level forecasts.
S&P; Global Market Intelligence / Bloomberg / Macrobond www.spglobal.com/marketintelligence/	Commercial terminals & feeds with regional/state series and history.

Private & alternative real-time sources

Source	Notes
Opportunity Insights - Economic Tracker github.com/OpportunityInsights/EconomicTracker	Free. State & county employment, consumer spending, job postings from anonymized card/payroll/postings partners. Caveat: COVID-era project - verify it is still updated; state employment series carries notable noise vs CPS.
Indeed Hiring Lab www.hiringlab.org/	Free, near-real-time job postings by state and metro (labor-demand signal).
Lightcast (formerly Emsi Burning Glass) lightcast.io/	Commercial. Granular job-postings and labor-market data by state/metro.
Card-spending vendors (Visa/Mastercard SpendingPulse, Fiserv, Affinity Solutions, Earnest) www.mastercard.com/news/insights/spendingpulse/	Commercial. State / ZIP consumer-spending panels at daily-weekly frequency.
Homebase joinhomebase.com/data/	Small-business hours-worked & employees-working, near real-time by geography.
Chmura JobsEQ / Zillow & Redfin / Apartment List www.chmuraecon.com/jobseq/	Sector-specific (labor, home prices, rents) - useful as activity & inflation proxies by state.

Geographic-coverage shorthand: "50 states + DC" is the standard federal panel; some programs add Puerto Rico (PR) and the US Virgin Islands (VI). "Regions" refers to the four Census regions / nine divisions. Items marked NOT individual states are the nearest official geography available for that indicator.